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Despite his rapid growth, transitioning into a professional set-up proved challenging. He got limited game time in the season which saw the Panthers clinch their second title. The following season was a major setback, as a fractured skull sustained during training forced him to miss the entire campaign.

Hurdles aside, Devank only cherishes his stint with the Jaipur franchise. Not only did he make his PKL debut, but he was also able to share the dressing room with stars like Rahul Chaudhari, Sunil Kumar, and Arjun Deshwal, among others.

"It was a surreal experience. I made my debut, and my team won the title. All the legends advised me to keep practising and be patient. They said that my time will also come and I have to be ready for that," he explained.

Undeterred by challenges, he consistently honed his fitness and skills. His impressive raiding performances in the Services and Inter-Services tournaments caught the eye of Pirates coach Narender Redu, who secured him at the auction for Rs. 20 lakhs.

The most successful franchise in PKL history took a gamble on a young raiding unit, a move that always carries risks but can also have rewarding payoffs if it goes well.

"Every player is a newcomer once; they should perform to earn a name. Devank is a hard-working individual, and his progress has been tremendous. I had a belief that he'll do well, but he's exceeded even my expectations," said the coach.

The Pirates have been the most successful raiding team this season, accumulating 438 raid points at an average of 24.33 points with an

average of 18.5 successful raids per match.

"My coach and teammates give me the confidence to go and attack and get the points. I have received a lot of support from the team management, and I want to make every opportunity count," the towering raider added.

Born on April 1, 2000, Devank acknowledges that he's a relatively late bloomer in PKL terms but is determined to improve every year. He is the first in his family to take up the sport, and now two of his younger siblings have followed in his footsteps.

"I want to try my best to ensure that my family has a good future. They've seen a lot of hardship, and now it's my turn to give back and help them live a happier life. They have done a lot for me, and I want to do something meaningful for them," he concluded.